

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

A PORTAL JUST **CAPPED** WHO GETS ITS LEADS.

If one platform runs your pipeline, that's a policy change away from disappearing.

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**20 PERCENT.
THAT'S THE NEW
CEILING ON ONE
BROKERAGE'S
SHARE OF THE
LEADS.**

StreetEasy just set that cap on its own invite-only lead program. Nobody at the brokerage voted on it.

THE CAP ISN'T THE STORY. WHO CONTROLS THE SWITCH IS.

StreetEasy, Zillow's New York City brand, capped its invite-only "Experts" lead program so no single brokerage can hold more than 20 percent of the agent base in it. Compass is currently the only company over that line, and Zillow says no current agent loses their spot, only new growth is restricted. This specific cap is a New York policy; Chicago agents aren't in this program. The part worth noticing anywhere: the platform marketed the cap as fairness, "agents at companies of every size have a meaningful opportunity to grow," while quietly proving the actual point, that the portal decides who gets access and can change the rule with no agent input and no advance vote. Whichever portal any agent depends on for leads holds that same switch.

DO THIS TO YOUR LEAD SOURCES THIS WEEK:

- 1** Add up what share of your last 12 months of leads came from one portal.
Over half, and
- 2** you're running a policy risk, not a marketing plan.
- 3** Build one lead source the portal can't touch.
A past-client list, a referral habit, a
- 4** market update email you send yourself. It has to be one you fully own.
- 5** Read the actual terms of any paid lead program you're in.
Find the clause on who can change
- 6** access, and how much notice you get before they do.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE PORTAL OWNS THE SWITCH. YOU SHOULD OWN THE LIST.

One platform's policy update shouldn't be able to end your pipeline.